



5 March 1953

DEATH OF STALIN

The Soviet Union's autocratic ruler died four days after suffering a cerebral haemorrhage, unleashing a struggle for power among his subordinates in the Central Committee of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union. Eventually, Nikita Khrushchev emerged victorious. In 1956, he denounced Stalin's crimes, attacking the personality cult that until that time had surrounded the dictator, particularly after his success in leading the USSR to victory in World War II.

◁ Stalin memorial rally in Bucharest

1953

27 July 1953 The Korean War ends with a ceasefire agreement

19 August 1953 Iran's Prime Minister Mohammad Mosaddegh is overthrown in a US-backed coup

7 May 1954 French forces surrender to Vietnamese insurgents at Dien Bien Phu: it is the end of French colonial rule in Indochina



△ Crowds celebrate in Cairo



◁ Muhammad Naguib, the first President of Egypt

18 June 1953

EGYPT BECOMES A REPUBLIC

In the wake of a military coup that had overthrown the reigning monarch King Farouk in August 1952, leaders of the revolutionary Free Officers Movement abolished the monarchy and declared Egypt to be a republic with Muhammad Naguib as President and Gamal Abdel Nasser as his deputy.

1 November 1954

ALGERIA'S WAR OF INDEPENDENCE BREAKS OUT

The war was one of the longest and bloodiest independence struggles that marked the end of the colonial era. It started when members of the FLN (National Liberation Front) launched a series of attacks on French targets and called on the Algerian people to rise up against the colonial authorities. The conflict, which also caused major political upheavals in France, only ended with the granting of independence in July 1962.



△ French mounted servicemen in Algeria